Week 11

Phrasal structure and Verb complementation

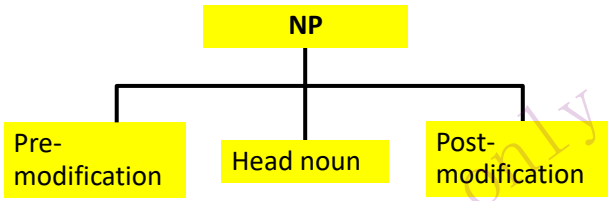
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Key issues

1. **Phrasal structure**
   - 1.1. Noun phrase
   - 1.2. Verb phrase
   - 1.3. Adjective phrase
   - 1.4. Adverb phrase
   - 1.5. Prepositional phrase
2. **Verb complementation**

1.1. Noun phrase

- Typically constructed by either a noun or a pronoun as the head & other constituents as modifiers.
- Apart from its head, all other constituents are optional.
- Functions as subject, object, complement or adverbial.



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Noun phrase

Can be expanded in many ways.

- N: *dogs*
- Det N: *the dogs*
- Det Adj N: *the large dogs*
- Det AdjP N: *the loudly barking dogs*
- Det Adj N PrepP: *the ferocious dog behind the fence*
- Det AdjP N PrepP: *the wildly yapping dog on the sofa*
- Pronoun: He
- Prounoun: Matty

(Brinton, 170)

1.2. Verb phrase

- A phrase headed by a verb
- May be constructed from a single verb or a combination of a main verb and any auxiliary verbs.
- Call
- Calls
- Called
- (Have) called
- Have been called
- Have been being called
- Will have been being called

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1.3. Adjective phrase

- A phrase with an adjective as head as in

  (He was) happy.

  (He was) so very happy.

- Can be expanded in many ways:

Adj	fierce
Degree Adj	very fierce
Adv Adj	fiercely barking
Degree Adv Adj	very fiercely barking
Adj PrepP	dear to me, tired of him

1.4. Adverb phrase

- A phrase that does the work of an adverb in a sentence
- Can be expanded as:

Adv	quickly
Degree Adv	very quickly

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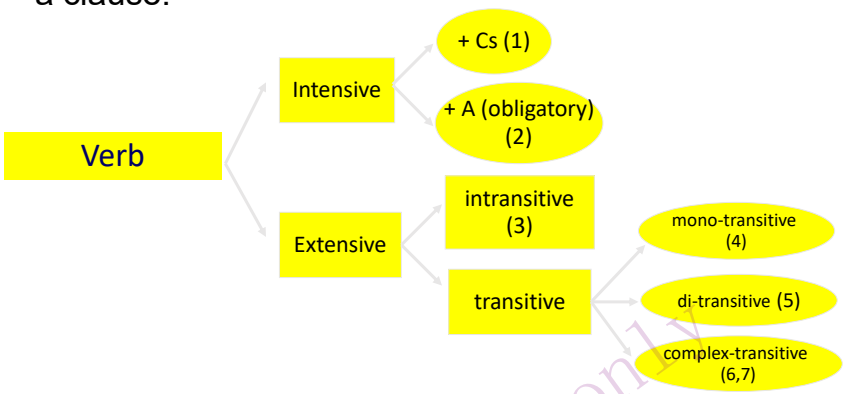
1.5. Prepositional phrase

- Typically consists of a preposition followed by a a NP or a *wh*-clause or V-**ing** clause.
- Can be expanded as:

Prep NP	on the beach
2Prep NP	from behind the door
3Prep NP	out from under the table

2. Verb complementation

- Not all verbs can stand alone. Below are units that complement verbs, which are generally obligatory in a clause.



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Verb complementation

He is lovely.	**SVCs (1)**	**intensive**	
He is out of the office.	**SVA (obligatory) (2)**		
He is crying.	**SV (3)**	**intransitive**	**extensive**
He broke the vase.	**SVO (4)**	**transitive**	
He sent me an e-mail.	**SVOO (5)**		
He found the play boring.	**SVOCo (6)**		
He put the vase on the table.	**SVOA (obligatory) (7)**		